

# THE FINAL CONFLICT

After many months of riding the hype machine, the last instalment of the immensely-popular *Halo* trilogy has finally hit the markets, and Microsoft's ensured that every Xbox-toting gamer has been sweating in anticipation. I don't usually have much hope after so much hype, but surprisingly enough, *Halo 3* lives up to a generous portion of it.



Rating : 9/10  
Developer : Bungie  
Publisher : Microsoft  
Distributor : Redington  
Platform : Xbox 360  
Contact : xbox360@redington.co.in  
Price : Rs 1,895

## The Script

The *Halo* games have a book's (two, even) worth of background pseudo-mythology behind them; for now, you must satisfy yourself with a condensed version. Humanity is at war with a fanatically religious race of aliens (go figure) called the Covenant, led by the Prophet of Truth. Humans are scum, and must be eradicated from the universe. Once that deed is done, they'll be taking their stairway to heaven by activating the Halo rings spread out around the universe. What they don't know (or choose to ignore) is that their path to salvation is really a highly destructive force that can wipe out all sentient life from the universe.

It's all social commentary on what's been happening in the world today—stupid, malicious things being done in the name of religion and all that. At the beginning of the game, you're reminded that the Covenant has located the Ark—a device that can remotely activate the Halos—on Earth (the reference to the Biblical Ark of the Covenant doesn't seem coincidental), so things might get a little uncomfortable rather swiftly.

You, as Master Chief Petty Officer John SPARTAN-117, will have none of this nonsense. You're back on Earth after your adventures from the previous game, ready to kick the Covenant's followers in hurtful places.